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21LEM202T — Unit 5, Session 5, SLO 1

Part B — In-Class Activity

Activity 1: Match each criterion to the correct area.

Criterion	Technology / Production / Management
Safe, user-friendly and conducive to health	**Technology**
What to produce, how to produce, for whom and how much	**Production**
Whole unit working as a well-knit family	**Management**
Compatible with natural systems and cycles	**Technology**
Priority for local consumption and local resources	**Production**
Participative mode and sharing of responsibility	**Management**

Activity 2 – Current Approach vs Holistic Approach

Complete the comparison.

Aspect	Current / Limited Materialistic View	Holistic View
Main goal	Profit / material gain only	**Mutual fulfilment / welfare of all**
Use of nature	Resource for exploitation	**Respectful coexistence / sustainable use**
Production	Mass production, centralised	**Decentralised, need-based production**
Management	Control / competition	**Cooperation / self-regulation**
Outcome	Resource depletion / pollution possible	**Harmony / sustainability / well-being**

Activity 3 – Mini Case Study Evaluation

Choose one case-study topic and evaluate it briefly.

Case-study topic	How it can satisfy holistic criteria
Water harvesting / watershed management	**It conserves water, recharges groundwater, supports local ecosystems, and involves community participation, fulfilling eco-friendly and people-friendly criteria.**
Organic / natural farming	**It avoids chemical inputs, maintains soil health, produces safe food, and respects natural cycles, satisfying eco-friendly and health-friendly criteria.**
Renewable decentralised energy	**It uses local renewable resources, reduces pollution, empowers communities, and ensures energy access, meeting eco-friendly and people-friendly criteria.**
Humanistic management model	**It prioritises employee well-being, mutual trust, and ethical decision-making, fostering a harmonious workplace and fulfilling people-friendly criteria.**

Part C — Long-Answer Questions

1. Answer in your own words, verifying each point on the basis of your natural acceptance.

1. Why is a holistic worldview needed for technologies, production systems and management models? (5 marks)

A holistic worldview is needed because the current materialistic approach leads to resource depletion, pollution, and social disharmony. A holistic view ensures that technologies, production systems, and management models are aligned with the well-being of all people and nature, promoting sustainability, mutual fulfilment, and long-term harmony. On the basis of natural acceptance, we inherently desire happiness and prosperity for all, which a holistic worldview alone can fulfil.

2. List and explain any five criteria for holistic technologies. (5 marks)

1. People-friendly: The technology should enhance human well-being and not cause harm to users or communities.

2. Eco-friendly: It should not deplete natural resources or pollute the environment; it should work in harmony with nature.

3. User-friendly: It should be easy to use, maintain, and accessible to all, especially local communities.

4. Decentralised: It should be suitable for local production and use, reducing dependence on centralised systems.

5. Sustainable: It should use renewable resources and ensure long-term viability without compromising future generations.

3. Explain the key questions and specific criteria for holistic production systems. (5 marks)

Key questions for holistic production systems include: What is produced? How is it produced? For whom is it produced? And what is the impact on nature and society? Specific criteria include: production should be need-based, not greed-based; it should use local resources and skills; it should minimise waste and pollution; it should ensure fair distribution and access; and it should promote self-reliance and community well-being.

4. Take one present technology/system and evaluate whether it is people-friendly, eco-friendly and user-friendly. Suggest one improvement. (5 marks)

I take the example of plastic packaging. It is not people-friendly because it often contains harmful chemicals and creates waste that harms health. It is not eco-friendly because it is non-biodegradable and pollutes land and oceans. It is user-friendly in terms of convenience and low cost. One improvement is to replace plastic packaging with biodegradable materials like plant-based films or reusable cloth bags, which would be more eco-friendly and still user-friendly.

Self-Reflection (Take-Home)

Which technology that I use daily is convenient but may not be eco-friendly or people-friendly?

What local resource or traditional practice can my community learn from?

In my branch/profession, what kind of project can support mutual fulfilment and preservation of nature?

The smartphone I use daily is convenient but not eco-friendly due to its mining for rare minerals, energy-intensive production, and e-waste; it may also not be people-friendly if produced under exploitative labour conditions. My community can learn from traditional rainwater harvesting and local organic farming practices that are sustainable and community-oriented. In my branch/profession (engineering), a project that supports mutual fulfilment and preservation of nature could be designing a low-cost solar-powered water purification system for rural areas, using locally available materials and involving community participation.